6 Federated computational governance

This chapter covers

- Understanding our definition of data governance
- Learning the key benefits of data governance
- Defining the expected deliverables of data governance
- Structuring data-related policies
- Federating data governance
- Making data governance computational

In chapter 4, we kick-started our data mesh and included a lot of governance work right from the start. This chapter dives deeper into how to perform this crucial step.

NOTE While we understand that you may want to get straight to the implementation of data governance, this would be counterproductive. This topic can be approached in too many ways. Governance centralization and automation may be implemented at many levels, creating a vast matrix, impossible to describe in a single chapter. Instead, we show you options and give you pointers on starting the governance design and implementation processes. Still, you need to envision how to utilize governance best to derive value in your organization.

First, we will discuss what data governance is and paint a broad picture of what it means to federate it and make it computational.

Second, we will explain why implementing data governance is a good idea. At the beginning of this book, we indicated that you could implement the principles we describe with varying levels of detail. The second section explains why this nontechnical activity may add value to your business.

Third, we present multiple data governance models. We will show you the extremes of the responsibility distribution—the centralized data governance model and the decentralized data governance model—and follow with the federated Governance model, which takes the best from both approaches and minimizes the downsides of each.